MICHAEL KATZ

Marketing & Entertainment Executive | Experiential Marketing Leader
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven marketing executive with 25+ years of progressive experience building and scaling experiential marketing operations. Proven track record of climbing every rung of the ladder—from campus brand ambassador to agency owner—developing deep expertise at each level. Founded and scaled two businesses: Alternative Brand Marketing ($1.5M+ agency revenue, 50+ brand programs) and Stress Free Group LLC ($5M+ gross revenue, 118 vehicles, 2,300+ reservations). Known for building scalable systems, recruiting and developing talent, and delivering measurable ROI across 5,000+ events and 1M+ product samples.

KEY METRICS

25+	5,000+	50+	$5M+
Years Experience	Events Produced	Brand Clients	Business Revenue

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Owner & President | Stress Free Group LLC | San Diego, CA October 2020 – Present

- Founded and scaled independent RV rental and fleet-management business spanning rentals, repairs, sales, logistics, and large-scale event support
- Built vertically integrated operations with direct ownership across P&L, compliance, and customer experience
- Grew fleet from 1 vehicle to 118 vehicles at peak capacity with 17 full-time staff
- Generated $5M+ gross revenue with 2,300+ customer reservations and industry-leading satisfaction ratings

Sr. National Director of Sales & Client Relations | Look Media USA / The Sampling Agency | San Diego, CA February 2016 – December 2019

- Hired for 6-week project; converted to multi-year contract in 2 weeks based on immediate results
- Created The Sampling Agency under Look Media umbrella, establishing new revenue vertical
- Brought in 40 new clients and $800K revenue increase through strategic business development

- Built proprietary Talent Portal software for scheduling, assignments, reporting, and photo uploads
- Managed database of 5,000+ contractors across 50 states for national activations

Brand Marketing Manager | Vino Beverages | New York, NY November 2014 – January 2016

- Led all marketing for alcohol-removed wine startup targeting health-conscious consumers
- Managed quarterly marketing plans with budgets ranging from $30K to $2M
- Built full convention calendar strategy generating 1,500+ qualified leads per quarter
- Moved 12,000+ units in first 6 months through integrated digital and experiential campaigns

Founder | Alternative Brand Marketing | New York, NY January 2011 – January 2021

- Founded full-service experiential marketing agency serving Fortune 500 and startup clients
- Led campaign strategy, national sales programming, staffing, and execution for 50+ brand programs
- Generated $1.5M+ in agency revenue with 20,000+ contractor database
- Delivered multi-market activations for clients including PepsiCo, Rémy Martin, and Evian

Regional Field Marketing Manager – East | O.N.E Natural Experience (PepsiCo) | Los Angeles / East Coast June 2011 – April 2013

- Promoted twice from Northeast to full East region; contributed to successful PepsiCo acquisition
- Managed 50 direct reports across 600+ events with $100K+ vendor cost savings
- Led major festival activations: Bonnaroo, Electric Zoo, Winter Music Conference, EDC

Account Producer | SoHo Experiential | New York, NY July 2010 – January 2013

- Managed premium spirits activations for Rémy Martin VSOP, Rémy Martin V, Grand Marnier
- Oversaw 50+ brand ambassadors and 500+ events over 3-year engagement
- Built nightlife and event activation programs across 20+ major markets

CORE COMPETENCIES

Experiential Marketing | Event Production | Brand Activation | Sampling Programs | Staff Recruitment & Training | Multi-Market Campaign Management | P&L Ownership | Vendor Negotiations | Strategic Partnerships | Business Development | CRM Systems | Festival Marketing | Nightlife Marketing | Spirits & Beverage | CPG | Entertainment

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts, Speech Communications
Hofstra University | Long Island, NY

SELECT CLIENTS

PepsiCo | Rémy Martin | Grand Marnier | Evian | Danone | Amazon | Audible | DirecTV | Samsung | Sony | HP | Intel | Qualcomm | Red Bull | Monster Energy | Vita Coco | Beanfields | Argo Tea | KIND Snacks | Anheuser-Busch | MillerCoors | Bacardi | Diageo